

Yi Xu (Phoebe), Ph.D.

Associate Professor

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

My research integrates *Human-Computer Interaction (HCI)* and *Cognitive Psychology* to examine the co-evolution of AI systems and human intelligence. I utilize a cross-disciplinary lens to investigate how AI agents and algorithmic platforms reshape human cognition, meta-cognition, and social behavior in high-stakes environments. Key focus areas include *Sense of Agency in human-AI collaboration*, *Algorithmic Fairness and Trust*, and *agent-augmented education* for cognitive growth and digital well-being (also labelled “agentic education” in industry discourse).

PUBLIC ENGAGEMENT & IMPACT

I actively translate AI-and-society research for non-academic audiences. Outputs include long-form posts on China’s **WeChat** 公众号 (China’s primary long-form platform, ~1.3B MAU parent app), media commentary, and publicly shared course-industry case studies.

- **Media coverage:** Featured expert in *新民晚报* (Xinmin Evening News) on older adults’ digital well-being and short-video platforms (Nov 2021), in a national seminar co-hosted by the China Population Association and Douyin.
- **Public scholarship:** Long-form course recaps on the ICCI WeChat 公众号 covering student-industry projects with **China Literature** (阅文), **Shanghai Jiushi Performance** (久事), and **Double Happiness** (红双喜) — reaching a professional audience across cultural-creative industries.
- **Research uptake:** Publications cited **600+ times since 2020** (Google Scholar); AI-fairness and digital-well-being work covered by Chinese mainstream media.

EDUCATION

The Chinese University of Hong Kong, Hong Kong

Ph.D in *Social Psychology* 2015

Columbia University, New York, NY, US

M.A. in *Developmental Psychology* 2008

Fudan University, Shanghai, China

B.S. in *Electronics Engineering* 2003

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Shanghai Jiao Tong University, Shanghai, China

USC-SJTU Institute of Cultural and Creative Industry (ICCI)

Assistant Professor 2016 - 2020

Associate Professor 2021 - Present

General Electric (GE) China

Procurement Manager

- Managed complex industrial supply chains for Wind Energy 2003 - 2006

TEACHING & CURRICULUM DESIGN

I advocate for an *Agentic Education* paradigm, viewing the classroom as a real-world testbed for studying and advancing human-AI symbiosis. My teaching practice bridges technical AI capabilities with humanistic insight, preparing students to become active creators in the AI era rather than passive users.

AI: Its Nature and Future An interdisciplinary core course that explores the fundamentals of both Artificial and Natural Intelligence. It integrates computer science and psychology to examine the evolution of machine intelligence, cognitive foundations, multimodal systems, large language models, and the ethical, social, and philosophical boundaries of AI-driven technologies. The course balances technical depth with critical humanistic reflection, helping students develop well-rounded AI literacy.

Digital Cultural and Creative Industries Research II A project-based learning (PBL) course focused on industry-oriented research. Students conduct in-depth investigations into digital creative sectors, including AIGC (AI-Generated Content), virtual humans, immersive media, and digital entertainment. The curriculum emphasizes business model innovation, frontier technology application, and leadership skills required in AI-integrated creative industries. Students work on real-world projects that combine research, prototyping, and strategic analysis. **Course outputs are publicly recapped on the ICCI WeChat 公众号 (e.g., industry field-visit reports with China Literature, Shanghai Jiushi Performance, and Double Happiness), reaching a broad professional audience and serving as a public-facing portfolio of the course.**

Selected Publications

Human-AI Interaction, Fairness & Trust

Xu, Y.*, Chen, Z., & Dong, M. (2025). Shaping the Fairness Journey: The Roles of AI Literacy, Explanation, and Interpersonal Interaction in AI Interviews. *International Journal of Human-Computer Studies*, 205, 103629. [CCF-A, SSCI Q1, IF: 6.5].

Xu, Y.*, Guo, J., Zhou, D., & Li, M. (2026). Chatbot or cheatbot? Moral judgments of AI usage in academic writing. *Education and Information Technologies*, 1-23.

Xu, Y.*, Huang, Y. J., Wang, J. H., & Zhou, D. (2024). How do employees form initial trust in artificial intelligence: Hard to explain but leaders help. *Asia Pacific Journal of Human Resources*, 62, e12402.

Xu, Y.* & Liu, Y. X. (2021). The impact of trust in technology and trust in leadership on the adoption of new technology from employee's perspective. *Advances in Psychological Science*, 29(10), 1711-1723. (in Chinese).

Digital Agency & Algorithmic Engagement

Xu, Y.*, Wang, J., & Chen, Z. (2025). Riding the short video wave: Sense of agency in motion among young users on *Douyin*. *New Media & Society*. [Communication Top Journal, SSCI Q1, IF: 8.1]

Xu, Y.*, Zhou, D., & Wang, W. (2023). Being my own gatekeeper: How I tell the fake and the real—Fake news perception between typologies and sources. *Information Processing and Management*, 60(2), 103228.

Xu, Y.*, Zhou, D., & Wang, W. (2024). Using and Believing—Exploring Public Trust in Online News Sources in China. *Journalism Practice*, 20(2), 475–493.

Xu, Y.*, Ye, Y. X., & Liu, Y. X. (2022). Understanding virtual gifting in live streaming by the theory of planned behavior. *Human Behavior and Emerging Technologies*, 8148077.

Xu, Y.* & Ye, Y. X. (2020). Who watches live streaming in China? Examining viewers' behaviors, personality traits and motivations. *Frontiers in Psychology*, 11, 1607.

Applied Cognitive Psychology & Digital Well-being

Xu, Y.*, Wang, R., He, S., Veldre, A., & Andrews, S. (2020). Is it smart to read on your phone? The impact of reading format and culture on the continued influence of misinformation. *Memory and Cognition*, 48, 1112–1127.

Xu, Y.*, Chen, Z., & Shi, Y. Y. (2026). A Push and a Pull: Dual Pathways of Family Influence on Older Adults' Smart Home Adoption. *International Journal of Human-Computer Interaction*, 1–20.

Zhou, D., Kong, F. K., & **Xu, Y.** (2025). Internet use and mental health of older adults: The chain mediating effect of the sense of social fairness. *Journal of Shanghai Jiao Tong University (Philosophy and Social Sciences)*, 33(7). (in Chinese).

Shi, Y. Y., **Xu, Y.***, & Qin, T. Y. (2025). Affordance Design for Mitigating Digital Vulnerability in Smart Tourism. *International Journal of Tourism Research*, 27(3), e70060.

Xu, Y.* & Zhou, D. (2023). Feeling Lonely, Engaging Online During the Outbreak of COVID-19: A Longitudinal Study of Chinese Older Adults. *Innovation in Aging*, 7(7), igado90.

Xu, Y.*, Shi, Y. Y., & Qin, T. Y. (2023). Challenges in Smart Tourism: A Media Content Analysis of Digital Barriers for Senior Tourists in China. *Information Technology & Tourism*, 25, 665-682.

Zhou, D., **Xu, Y.***, & Ai, P. Y. (2022). The Effects of Online Social Interactions on Life Satisfaction of Older Chinese Adults. *Healthcare*, 10(10), 1964.

Xu, Y.* & Huang, Y. J. (2021). Chinese middle-aged and older Adults' Internet Use and Happiness: The Mediating Roles of Loneliness and Social Engagement. *Journal of Applied Gerontology*, 40(12), 1846-1855.

Culture Dynamics & Social Psychology

Liu, Y. & **Xu, Y.*** (2024). Residual and emergent: Good mother ideals in China and the role of cultural values. *Family Relations*, 73(5), 3586-3602.

Xu, Y. & Zhang, Y. (2023). Institutional trust and prosocial behavior in China: an experimental approach. *The Journal of Social Psychology*, 163(1), 79-93.

Xu, Y.* & Shen, R. (2022). Aesthetic evaluation of Chinese calligraphy: A cross-cultural comparative study. *Current Psychology*, 44, 28163–28176.

Hamamura, T. & **Xu, Y. (2015)**. Changes in Chinese culture as examined through changes in pronouns usage. *Journal of Cross-Cultural Psychology*, 46, 930-941.

RESEARCH GRANTS

NATIONAL & PROVINCIAL RESEARCH GRANTS

Principal Investigator, *The influence of trust on the adoption of new technologies and its underlying mechanism*, **National Natural Science Foundation of China (NSFC)**, Young Scholars Grant (No. 71902113). **Funding: RMB 200,000** (2020–2022).

Principal Investigator, *The strategic development of Shanghai cultural and creative industry parks*, **Shanghai Municipal Government Research Fund**. **Funding: RMB 100,000** (2020–2021).

Project Lead (Expert Consultant), *Annual Survey and Report on Culture, Tourism, and Technology in Shanghai*, **Shanghai Municipal Administration of Culture and Tourism** (2023,2024, 2025).

INTERNATIONAL PARTNERSHIP & COLLABORATION AWARDS

Principal Investigator, *Solutions to Collective Action Problems: A cross-country study*, **Warwick-SJTU Partnership Collaboration Award (PCA)**. **Funding: RMB 200,000** (2023–2024).

Principal Investigator, *Is it smart to read on your phone? A cross-cultural collaboration*, **Sydney-SJTU Partnership Collaboration Award (PCA)**. **Funding: AUD 20,000** (2018–2019).

Principal Investigator, *Live Streaming from a Culture Perspective*, **SJTU-USC (University of Southern California)** Zizhu New Media Management Research Fund. **Funding: USD 30,000** (2017–2020).

INDUSTRY & UNIVERSITY RESEARCH INITIATIVES

Selected Principal Investigator, *Tencent Social Value Open Research Plan* (2025).

Principal Investigator, *Youth Populism: Social Psychological Mechanisms and Interventions*, **SJTU Think Tank Pilot Research Fund**. **Funding: RMB 100,000** (2020–2021).

Principal Investigator, *Research of video quality of experience with perceptual psychology*, **SJTU Cross-Discipline Research Fund**. **Funding: USD 15,000** (2017–2020).

Principal Investigator, *Marie's Cultural Products TikTok Global Promotion Strategy*, **DHS Group Industry-Education Integration Project. Funding: RMB 52,000** (2025)

SELECTED CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

2024 International Communication Association (ICA) Annual Meeting | Gold Coast, Australia

Award: HYBRID Top Paper Award (Human-Machine Communication Division)

Title: *Navigating the Algorithmic Terrain: Unraveling the Influence of Literacy and Transparency on User Engagement across four platforms.*

2024 International Association of Cross-Cultural Psychology (IACCP) | Bali, Indonesia

Title: *Mitigating the Digital Divide in the Age of Digitalization: Inclusive Affordance of e-Tourism Service*

2024 Frontiers in Tourism Research Forum | Shanghai, China

Role: Session Discussant (Tourism Marketing & Consumer Behavior).

Title: *The Impact of Senior Tourism Short Videos on the Aging Attitudes of Middle-aged and Older Adults.*

2024 Gerontological Society of China (Geriatric Psychology Branch) | Beijing, China

Topic: *Digital Well-being and Mental Health of Older Adults.*

2023 8th China Media Credibility Forum | Jiashan, China

Topic: *Fake News Perception and Digital Media Trust.*

2022 Annual Conference of Tourism Science | Online

Role: Session Discussant.

Topic: *Digital Technology and Service Innovation*

2021 Elderly Psychology and Active Health Academic Conference | China

Topic: Oral presentation on **Digital Well-being** for the aged population.

2021 Chinese Psychological Society (Cultural Psychology Branch) | Online

Topic: *China's Cultural Dynamics and Psychological Changes.*

PROFESSIONAL CERTIFICATIONS & AFFILIATIONS

Vice Chairperson, Social Psychology Committee, Shanghai Psychological Association

Vice Chairman, 2nd Pudong Cultural and Creative Youth Council

National Level II Psychological Counselor, Ministry of Human Resources and Social Security of China

Featured media expert on digital well-being and AI–society issues (e.g., *新民晚报* interview, 2021)